

Northwind Technologies - Employee Handbook

1. Working Hours

Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday to Friday, with a one hour lunch break. Employees are expected to be reachable during the core collaboration window of 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM in their local time zone. Flexible start times between 8:00 AM and 10:30 AM may be arranged with a reporting manager, provided the core window is covered.

2. Annual Leave

Full-time employees are entitled to 21 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Leave accrues at 1.75 days per completed month of service. New joiners may take accrued leave during their probation period, but not more than 5 days. A maximum of 8 unused leave days may be carried forward into the following calendar year; anything beyond 8 days lapses on 31 December. Leave requests must be submitted at least 7 calendar days in advance through the HR portal, except in emergencies.

3. Sick Leave

Employees receive 12 days of paid sick leave per calendar year, separate from annual leave. A medical certificate is required for any absence of three consecutive days or longer. Sick leave does not carry forward.

4. Parental Leave

Birthing parents are entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave. Non-birthing parents are entitled to 6 weeks of paid paternity leave, which must be taken within 6 months of the child's birth or adoption. Both may be combined with annual leave.

5. Probation Period

The standard probation period is 90 days from the date of joining. During probation, either party may terminate employment with 15 days notice. After confirmation, the notice period is 60 days.

6. Dress Code

Northwind operates a smart casual dress code. Formal business attire is expected for client meetings and external presentations. There is no dress code on days when an employee is working remotely.

7. Code of Conduct

All employees must treat colleagues, clients and vendors with respect. Harassment, discrimination and retaliation are grounds for immediate termination. Concerns may be raised anonymously through the ethics hotline at ethics@northwind.example, which is monitored by an external firm.